

Character-Changing Prayer

Open to Mark 4 again, Mark the fourth chapter. We are going to pray, and when we begin it will be with the thirteenth verse. We are going to pass in review briefly and take this a step further.

Things are running in so many different directions in my spirit. I do not mean that in an unteachable sense. I mean I can hear things, and I am just waiting for God to put them together. He will. I can feel the Teacher tonight. Glory to God. I can feel the Teacher.

We have been studying this all week. I have made mention every night how important it is to me that if you had asked me two or three years ago, "Are you walking in peace?" I would have said, "Certainly," because I did not have now to compare then to.

Since this hunger to know God has pulled me into Him, I have never had any trouble loving God. I had problems in the past loving people. I kept trying to give them back to God like Moses did, and it seemed like He did not want them either.

It did not take me long to find out that I could only draw so close into God before He caused the love in me that was reaching for Him to go horizontal. He began to make statements and back them up with the Word on the inside of me, like, "My love is perfected in you as you have love one for another."

If I ever had trouble with verses, it was verses like, "How can you love God whom you cannot see, and not love men whom you can see?" I would think the whole time, "That is my problem. I can see them. If they were not here, I would not have any problem loving them."

Last night we found out that two of the major keys to purging us of the kind of unbelief Satan ceilings our lives and churches with are prayer and fasting. It is that subtle, deceptive kind of unbelief. Satan will come on the scene, seduce us, seduce our businesses, seduce our churches, and put a ceiling on them. The problem is that he is so evasive, seductive, and deceptive that we do not even know he is the one doing it. That is where his power comes from.

It would not be deception if you knew you were being deceived. He has taken men of God out. He has transformed once-moves of God into dead religious organizations. He has put ceilings on businesses that started as givers. When it was over, they never knew who did it.

So we studied the power in prayer and fasting. They asked, "Why would that devil not come out?" Jesus said, "Because of your unbelief." Then He went on and said, "You can move this mountain hence to yonder place," and made an incredible statement that few have ever dared to believe in any generation since Jesus:

Nothing shall be impossible unto you.

He said, "Learn to deal with this kind of subtle unbelief, the kind Satan uses to seduce and neutralize without people knowing who did it. Deal with it, and nothing shall be impossible to you."

Much to our amazement, we found out that prayer had more to do with us than with the circumstances around us. Fasting had more to do with us than with the circumstances around us. When He said, "Howbeit this kind cometh not out but by prayer and fasting," it certainly was not the prayer they uttered over the boy to get him delivered. That one did not work.

So the prayer He was talking about is the kind that changes us. The mountain is not your problem. Lack of finances is not your problem. Your husband or wife is not your problem. Your problem is whether or not you can believe that they are gone.

We got into the prayer aspects and found out that most enduring prayer will first work on us. It will first work on us and bring us to a place in Him. Then we found out that is what fasting does. Fasting first works on us to bring us to a place.

We studied prayer in God's government and found this out. He said:

Concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant.

That makes us even, you know. Then He went on to outline the government of God.

There are nine gifts of the Spirit, and these nine gifts empower the five ministerial offices of apostle, prophet, teacher, evangelist, and pastor. These nine gifts that envelop and qualify the five offices are all enveloped in eight operations of God.

You and I are called to fill one of these eight operations, which He named when He said, "God hath set some in the body, first apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers, after that workings of miracles and gifts of healings," which envelop the pastoral and evangelistic offices. Then He went on to the sixth operation, helps; the seventh operation, governments; and the eighth operation, the foundation operation, diversities of tongues.

That one is at the bottom of the list because the other seven rest on it. Of all the operations, this one qualifies you because it is the only operation where you invite God on the inside of you to get involved with your spirit, where all change takes place. It is called the baptism of the Holy Spirit and results in diversities of tongues.

There are four diversities of tongues.

First, tongues for personal edification. Second, tongues that present themselves in the public assembly for the sole purpose of interpretation. Third, tongues that extend into the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit and empower a believer to stand in the gap for family, city, or nation before his God. Fourth, tongues that present themselves as a sign to the unbeliever, when the Holy Ghost transcends your intellect and empowers you to testify, teach, or preach in a language you had no previous knowledge of. That one has happened to me nine times. I like it.

Of these four diversities in this eighth operation, two are designed for use in the public assembly: tongues for interpretation, and tongues as a sign to the unbeliever. Two are designed for use in your prayer closet: tongues for personal edification, and tongues that extend into the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit.

That brings us down to these two.

The rules that govern tongues for the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit are as different as night and day from the rules that govern tongues for personal edification.

I wish I could groan in the Spirit any time I pleased, cause great revival, and make the strong man fall in my city and come running into my church. But I cannot. That is severely as He wills. I wish I could. Again, I say there are people who think they can, and they wonder why it never produces anything but flakiness. Everything is wrong.

Rick Renner, a personal friend of mine, got into a groaner church. In that church the pastor stood up and said, "I used to do that little shimmy-shimmy tongue until I found out there was not any power in it. Now I am a groaner."

The moment Rick got done teaching, the whole church doubled over, grabbed their stomachs, and started groaning. Rick thought, "My God, what did I get myself into?"

I have seen them get so strange that I just do not have much time for it. When they bring the buckets out and it is not for an offering, it is time for me to leave. When they pull water guns out as symbols of authority and cast the devil out, saying, "Get out, get out," then point at him supposedly as he walks out and re-holster their water guns, I am through with that prayer meeting.

I cannot help what happens to people. I wonder how sane, educated people can suddenly think intercession is barking like a dog or crowing like a rooster.

One time an intelligent evangelist sat next to me. He sounded so intellectual, with such command of language that it put me to shame. I thought, "My God, I have to get up after this guy."

After he testified, he bent over to me and said, "I heard you are an intercessor."

I said, "Well, I guess."

He said, "When you are at the height of the groanings, when the power is on you, does that barking anointing ever come on you?"

I thought something was wrong with my ear. He said it again. I looked him in the face to figure out whether he was joking. He looked so serious that I thought, "Either he is a poker player or he believes this stuff."

I said, "No, I cannot say that it has."

He said, "You know, we walk around on our hands and bark."

I said, "You do that in intercession?"

"Yes," he said. "And the rooster anointing."

There is only one diversity in this eighth operation of divers tongues that I can pray in any time I want. The deep groanings of intercession flow through me as God empowers me, because I am a citizen of two kingdoms. One is the kingdom of God, because I have been born again. But I am still possessing this body, so I am also a citizen of this earthly kingdom, and that gives me authority here.

When God comes to me and wants to use that authority to move things here, He privileges me by sliding me into the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit. He places me between a catastrophe that is about to take place, one of my boys about to get killed, or a bunch of people trying to go to hell, and I stand in the gap. I release God to move, and He sends angels, people, and everything else. He can do anything if He can find an intercessor.

That is why I wish I could operate in it any time I want. But I cannot.

There is only one I can operate in any time I want, as much as I want, wherever I want: tongues for personal edification. All the other gifts flow through you for the edification of others. This one flows to you for your own edification. So He has done with this one what He has done with no other: He has made you the steward of your own edification. He has made you the steward of its operation.

It is this tongue that most people in prayer will spend large amounts of time in. I am going to warn you. Take it or not, and it does make a difference to me whether you take it, because I do not want to see you floundering around for the next five years in fruitless land.

Watch the teachings that say everybody can be an intercessor, and that the little personal-edification tongue will not work, that you have to have a militant, warring tongue.

When you are praying in tongues, you are not even talking to the devil. You are talking to God. The devil is completely left out. He would like to understand what you are saying, but he does not.

At times in the diversities of tongues, God may move through you, switch the tongue, switch the anointing as He wills, and issue orders in the tongues of men and angels. But that is not tongues for personal edification, and you do not operate the other at your will. The only one you operate at your will is tongues for personal edification.

So it does not matter whether you shout, pray quietly, sit curled up in a chair with nothing but your mouth moving, or pray so softly someone has to put an ear close to hear you. It does not make any difference because your spirit is praying.

It is not the kinetic energy of your flesh that gives it power. The Holy Spirit is creating the words and using the authority in your spirit to release them. Those words are changing your life because they are tongues for personal edification. God the Holy Ghost is praying for you, if you have time.

This is where you learn enduring prayer. It is the one you spend most of your time in. It is the first power flow you enter in the eighth operation. You can pray ten hours, fifteen hours, a hundred hours, and not wear yourself out. That was my first transition from altar holiness, when I thought I had to work myself into it, to hour after hour in motel rooms and cars.

What matters is that those words are being created supernaturally by God the Holy Spirit, and He is praying one of the most powerful, changing, edifying prayers anyone in the universe could pray for you.

Tongues for personal edification is the number-one power flow.

The second power flow is this. After you are in tongues for personal edification, you begin to edify and charge yourself up. The Word begins to be lit. Illumination takes place. Pretty soon things you want to get rid of in your life come forward and are put to death.

But there is a problem. Things you do not want to get rid of also come forward.

Self-exaltation is a higher purging, one of the things that puts big ceilings on your life. The same is true of the security in money: money, money, money. That can get hold of a person. There is security in it, and they cannot give it up. They want to be godly, but they want both masters.

"Please do not ask me to give away past my last million."

So he goes to prayer. Edification, edification, light, light, light. Finally that character flaw is pulled into the light, and God says, "Make a decision."

"Why can I not have both? Let me keep this too."

The more you pray, the more you face yourself. Sometimes you can get depressed over it. You think, "I am not going. I am switching churches."

You did yourself a disservice. Go somewhere they do not care whether you have a reward when you enter heaven or not. This has been a problem with churches. We go in and say, "Pastor, I want it this way and this way, and if you do not change it, there are plenty of churches that will." So what do they do? They change it.

Do you think they did you a favor? They did not.

Pastors juggle sheep, stand on their heads, build gymnasiums, and put swimming pools in them. The sheep are happy because it is like getting a new car. But like any new car, it wears off, and the same God-hunger and the same inability to stand through problems remain, because nobody cared about anything but fleecing your wool.

When He brings you to the place where He starts pulling out higher character flaws, like the love of money, self-exaltation, torments, and fears that keep you from moving out in God, He pulls them to the forefront because you are never in better condition to handle their death than when you have been edified.

"But my emotions feel worse than they have ever felt before."

Yes, because you are producing more power than you have ever produced before. Your emotions got you in trouble last year, did they not? So why are you trusting the lying scoundrels this time?

The second power flow comes when He finally gets you to stick long enough to get enough power in you so you can face yourself. Then He kicks in a minor form of intercession where you literally stand in the gap for yourself as He pulls these ugly things out and you feel them. You remain faithful to prayer, and they start dying one at a time. God replaces them with peace.

Then you are on your way to the third power flow, the deep, intercessional, gap-standing groanings, because you have lost a bunch of the handles the devil could use to pull you out of prayer any time he wanted last year. Now he does not have those handles anymore. God can put you in the gap and get many people saved through your prayer.

That sets you up for the fourth power flow: joyful waves of glory and refreshing that flow over a person after a major war and the stronghold has fallen. It is celebration time.

You may be praying in edification and suddenly He switches the flow. Immediately, like a woman about to give birth, you want to go somewhere alone. Sometimes it comes for hours. I will roll, feel like I am going to die, and sometimes the lostness of people comes on me. I feel abandoned, alone, and lost, and that adds to my agony until the tears are hot and I hurt and cry and groan until He lifts it.

I was teaching at a preacher's conference when a woman jumped up and began to groan. I said, "My God, that woman is in deep intercession. Ushers, there is a little room in the back. Put her in it, because she will probably be in it for days."

She was back in three minutes. No show, no flow.

After those deep warring times, here comes the wave of glory. Refreshing flows over you. It is incredible when the Holy Spirit passes through a man to bring an edification report that says, "A stronghold has fallen."

Those are the four power flows.

Now you are beginning to understand what I said at the beginning of the week. I was in a Rick Renner meeting at the tape table waiting for him, and a little intercessor stepped up and said, "I want to be an intercessor in the worst way. I just want to pray. But I knew this intercessor, and she prayed so much in tongues that she got weird."

I could not take it anymore. I stepped between her and Rick Renner and said, "If you get weird, it will be because you had a capacity to be weird."

What happens to people who get weird is that when the Holy Spirit brings them to the second power flow, He holds up a mirror and says, "I would like to show you an ugly thing about yourself that you do not want to turn loose."

You look at it and say, "I like my money."

He says, "How about the self-exaltation?"

"I like that too."

Maybe you say, "I am not going to do anything around the church if I do not get seventy-six slaps on the back for it. I am addicted."

The Holy Ghost brings you face to face with those things, and if you do not want to get rid of them, it does not matter. If you keep praying in tongues, He will bring them back with force until you deal with them, or you will go out mad at everybody, get strange about it, and tell people that tongues will make you weird if you pray too much. That is a lie.

Let us understand where this is bringing you. We have been talking about peace. This carries a package of stillness, dominant security, and peace. It talks louder than any problem and says, "It is all fine. You are secure in Me." That is where you are heading when you choose to believe what God says over all your problems.

It is not enough to know He said you are supposed to cast your care on Him. We preach that: humble yourself under the mighty hand of God, casting the whole of your care over on Him, for He cares for you. We go into great detail about how to do it. You roll all your cares into a package and roll them over onto Jesus. He has wide shoulders. That is great in theory, but how do you get it off the page?

You smile and say, "I left all my cares at the altar. I made the quality decision. I am not going to worry anymore."

Unfortunately, worry is an emotion. It is like love. You do not just reach up and flip it off because you found the switch.

You roll them over on Jesus and go home that night, but your cares drove faster than you did. When you got home, they were waiting for you. They say, "How did you do? I got here first. I am about to leap on you. You can resist, but I am going to visit you tonight. You are going to wake up in a cold sweat. You are going to worry."

He said:

Humble yourselves therefore under the mighty hand of God... casting all your care upon him; for he careth for you.

Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may devour.

He is doing inspections, looking for people with care, because care qualifies you to be devoured. Then He said, "Whom resist stedfast in the faith."

I used to think resisting the devil meant a nervous, hyper kind of faith: "I rebuke you, devil. I rebuke you too. Now he is coming in the front door. I rebuke you." That was a full-time job.

But if care is what makes you devourable, then the way you resist the devil is by resisting taking the care. If you do not have it, he cannot devour you.

"How do I get rid of it?"

I am glad you asked, little voice of unbelief.

He said, "Humble yourself under God's hand." Become teachable under the mighty hand of God, that He may exalt you in due time. The way you humble yourself under His hand is under His Word. The Holy Ghost, in that eighth operation, desires to purge these things out of you if you will let Him. That is why He says it is through the Spirit that you mortify the deeds of the body.

It does not do me any good to stand up here and say, "You all need to walk in love." You say, "Thank you for telling me. I knew that the whole time. Just before I yelled at my wife, I knew that." I can preach it and tell you, but I cannot open you up and put it on the inside of you. You have to turn yourself over to the Holy Ghost for that.

Husbands and wives at each other's throats go to marriage counselors. They get books: "Do yourself a favor and love your wife." "Do yourself a favor and love your husband."

For a week or two there are roses, candlelight dinners, foot massages, and breakfast in bed. You think, "We should have gotten these books a long time ago." But six weeks later the old character rises up again.

It is the same when we try to mortify the flesh with extreme willpower, especially in dieting. New Year's resolutions are the things you break. You eat salad, discipline yourself, and the weight comes off day after day. Then something from within attacks your willpower. You pass a bakery and the next thing anyone knows, something has gone through that bakery and left icing everywhere.

This is what we have been doing with our youth. We say, "Let us create a program and keep them so busy they do not have time to go into the world." The problem is that if you feed them through that busy thing and do not turn them over to the Holy Ghost, they come out the other side the same as they went in.

We are supposed to teach people how to turn themselves over to the Holy Ghost in the eighth operation, so He can turn them over to Jesus and do what willpower cannot do. He is the One who gets on the inside of your spirit, where all permanent change comes from.

When you pray in the Holy Ghost, God is praying out of the part of you where the roots die. How many times have we picked the flesh-fruit off the tree and said, "I will never do that again," but failed to destroy the root? It was only a matter of time before the flesh and those character flaws grew back on the tree.

Why? Because we have not learned how to turn ourselves over to the Holy Spirit and let Him mortify the deeds of the body.

We are doing you a favor when we push and push for you to come spend time in prayer. I know you think I am only making intercession for the city. In truth, you are bringing yourself to a place where you eventually will make intercession, because you will be strong, character flaws will be put to death, the love of God will be birthed, the devil will not be able to manage you, and you will become someone God can use.

I was hoping to make it to Mark 4, but instead let us go over to Hebrews 11. We are going to look at faith, because that is what we are all after. Who does not want to say to this mountain, "Be removed and cast into the sea"?

When the Lord told me to bring it together tonight, I was happy because I thought maybe He was going to make me get out there and really chop you up. He said, "I gave them a good bite."

When I was going to bring you through Mark 4, He said the sower sows the Word, and persecutions, afflictions, cares of this life, the deceitfulness of riches, and the lusts of other things entered in and choked the Word, and it became unfruitful.

He called persecutions and afflictions stony ground. But you have to understand, when the Word was sown into that ground, the stone already lay beneath the surface. That is what hindered the growth of the Word. You are the recipient of the Word. The Word is sown on your heart. These are they who become offended over persecutions and afflictions.

The stone existed in the ground already when the Word was sown. It was the stone that gave the devil the authority in your life to offend you and cause you not to choose the Word.

He said these are they that are sown among thorns. The thorns already existed in this ground. The cares of this life, the deceitfulness of riches, and the lusts of other things entered in and choked the Word, and it became unfruitful. Again, the thorns already existed when the Word was sown. It was the thorns that gave the devil authority to cancel the operation of the Word out of your life.

If you did not have a capacity to be choked, persecuted, or afflicted, then the devil would have nothing to empower him to mess up your life with. The stones and thorns are what he has to have on your part to stop you. That is what the Word is purging out.

He did not tell you that you had those things to classify you as eternally lost. He was saying those things gave the devil the authority to stop you.

Then He said these are good ground, such as hear the Word and bring forth thirty, sixty, and a hundredfold.

| Is a candle lit to be hid under a bushel, or to be set on a candlestick?

Is the Word of God given to you not to understand? No. The Word of God is given to you for the same reason a candle is lit and put on a tabletop. It is supposed to illuminate a dark room. You do not light a candle unless you need the light.

He said that is the function of the Word when it enters your dark life. It immediately shines light on every area where the thorns and stones live.

You say, "I want a hundredfold."

He says, "Let Me show you how you will get it."

There is nothing hid, which shall not be manifested; neither was any thing kept secret, but that it should come abroad.

If your heart is desperately seeking a hundredfold, then there are no stones and no thorns that will stop you. He will make sure that when He ignites the Word, it shines light on all those thorns and stones. When that brilliant light shines, He will give you the power, through illumination and revelation knowledge at the hands of the Holy Spirit, to cut out the stones and remove the thorns. That is what makes your ground productive.

Most of us do not require much of a devil to handle us. We get low-level, cheap, expendable ones. A little persecution and affliction will do it. That stone inside your ground gives them authority. It is their foundation. They remove the Word out of you, and you roll around in circles the rest of your life, entering heaven with nothing.

But then we get more serious and say, "I am not going to let those little things bother me. It is going to take a good dose of cares."

So the devil has a program streamlined for the person who makes it past stony ground. These are they that are sown among thorns, and the thorns choke the Word. They have a strangling effect, a long-lasting, long-enduring pressure like the cares of this world.

The weight of it. Disquietment. Apprehension. "I am an adult. I have a family. I have children. Where is this world going? The economy, Black Monday, the stock market, a one-world monetary system, the mark of the beast, an unsure economy, the ozone layer, the atmosphere."

Cares usually take a person over when they enter a realm of responsibility. Family. Ministry. Anything. It weighs on them, and the devil throws the cares at them: "What are you going to do? It is over. Your budget did not come in. You lost your job. You have no unemployment and six kids. When has God answered prayer for you?"

Finally they throw up their hands and leave God. The cares of this life choke the Word, and the answer He had for them is choked out because they stopped.

If you make it past adversity, the devil switches tactics. Persecutions, afflictions, and cares all deal with adversity. When it comes to adversity, the flesh looks for a way out. But when it comes to pleasure, the flesh looks for a way in.

If you survive persecutions, afflictions, and cares, you are tough. Trouble will not knock you out. So he switches tactics after care and enters into the deceitfulness of riches. If he cannot beat you out, he wants to suck you in.

We had better talk about the deceitfulness of riches, because there is only one left after that: the lusts of other things. That deals with self-exaltation and glory hunting. That is what the devil fell over. He wanted to be like God.

You will find that ministries that survived even money and women, like Dowie and Branham, had such powerful gifts that people still meet and worship their memory, believing they will be resurrected. Those must have been tremendous gifts those men walked in.

Money did not get them. Branham was humble. Every dime was accounted for. If the budget was met prematurely, he would quit taking offerings. There are not many like that today.

Dowie and Branham both survived that. But what got them? The devil said, "I cannot use persecutions and afflictions. They survived those. They survived the cares of this life. I cannot use the deceitfulness of riches. They survived that. I only have one left."

The lust for other things is so deceptive and powerful because most of the time preachers, people, and businesses are taken out without knowing who did it. The devil begins dropping suggestions: "Is there any other like you in the land? Who has a gift like yours? Elijah is to come."

Pretty soon, without actually saying it, a man begins to teach, "Who else qualifies? He must come before the return of Jesus. Who else has a ministry that would qualify?"

Just before he was killed in a car wreck, Branham began to think he was Elijah to come. That self-exaltation is the last one people fall over. Dowie built the city of Zion as a refuge for Christians to come from all over the world to be healed. He too began to think he was Elijah to come.

Do you think it is coincidental that both men began thinking the same thing, if there was not a force out there causing them to think that way?

Most of us do not have to worry much about the lust for other things. We do not make it past the deceitfulness of riches.

I used to think prosperity was based on something other than what it is based on, but since entering that room of peace, I have found out that Godliness with contentment is gain. He said there are those who suppose gain is godliness, and they are destitute of truth. From such, turn away.

Can you imagine being labeled destitute of truth? Destitution is total abandonment by the necessities, and He says these men are destitute of truth because they suppose gain is godliness.

If gain is not godliness, what is?

Godliness with contentment is great gain.

For we brought nothing into this world, and it is certain we can carry nothing out.

He was not discrediting prosperity. He was saying that what qualifies you for prosperity is the peace and contentment of God. Contentment and peace are the qualifier.

Why? Because the devil can come in and fight you, and if you lose seven million temporarily, it will not make a bit of difference because you have contentment. You can turn around and get it all back. Or you can be broke, and God can drop a billion dollars on you around the corner. It makes no difference, because whether you are out of money or have it all, the devil cannot use it as a tool when you have peace and contentment.

There is no force quite like money. If you have a thorn or a stone and money comes into your life, the devil will take hold of that money and put pressure on the stone or thorn. If one is there, the power in money will twist you up.

I thought, "God, is the qualification for getting rich getting rid of the thorns and stones?"

He said, "You got it. Then I become the causer. When I cause, everybody in the world can sue you, and I will come in the front door and give it all back, because I am the causer."

The sun shines on the sinner and the saint. The laws of reaping and harvest work: the sinner sows a field and harvests it.

That is why He said, "Be ye therefore merciful." You can afford to be merciful to the sinner. You have God.

I could not understand Luke 6. He says that when a man sues you to take your coat, give him your cloak also. If he slaps you in the face, offer the other cheek. Love your enemies, do good to them that hate you, and pray for those who spitefully use you.

That does not sound like a successful businessman. When the man is suing me for my coat, I am supposed to give him my cloak? When he is slapping me on the cheek, I am supposed to turn the other one? In the middle of all this, when he is taking my house and everything away from me, did I show mercy to him by letting him do it?

Yes. I may be the only thing blocking him from going to hell. If he can sue me over my testimony, if that is what it costs to give it, I will give it, and he will listen. He is taking everything I have, and I am having mercy on him by letting him do it.

The next verse says:

Judge not, and ye shall not be judged: condemn not, and ye shall not be condemned: forgive, and ye shall be forgiven:

Give, and it shall be given unto you; good measure, pressed down, and shaken together, and running over...

He is talking about the person who walks in love. They are stealing your goods out the back door, and without a crying, underlined prayer list, begging and pleading for money, God is causing people to come in the front door with ten times what you had.

If you have a stone or thorn and come into money, the devil will use that money to put pressure on the stone or thorn. But if the thorns and stones are gone, God becomes the causer.

I was praying desperately about revival in third-world countries as opposed to revival in first-world countries. Until I entered into peace, God could not show me the answer He showed me.

Something hurt me badly. I was in a large church, and there was a woman sitting in a wheelchair. I kept waiting for God to tell me to go over and pull her out, but He never did. Then I found out her story. She was desperately saving money to go with her pastor to Africa because her pastor had brought back videos of people with blind eyes healed and invalids restored. Something like thirty thousand people had been healed in his crusade.

This woman was in his church, and she was saving money to go to the third-world country with him so she could sit in the invalid section, and when he prayed for the sick, she could jump up with the rest of them. When he got back to America, he did not have that anointing.

I have found that to be true, and I always wondered why. Preachers come from the third world and tell about great miracles. You think, "We are going to see some," but when you bring the sick out, almost nothing happens. You are disappointed because you heard all the great things.

My question to God was this: "Why an anointing like this in the third world, and yet it seems there is an invisible perimeter where, when I cross into first-world America, the anointing is cut in half? I do not understand."

I asked those who seemed to be somewhat among them. They told me, "Those people are on their last leg. They are poor. They have no money. You are their last hope. If they do not get healed, they die."

If that is the case, I can empty the hospitals here of people doctors and religion are through with. I can fill an auditorium with people no one can help, and I will be their last hope too.

Another man said, "They have simple, childlike faith."

I thought, "It must be simple, because I preach one message through a broken translation, and people start jumping out of wheelchairs. The translator probably slaughtered what I said, and they still jumped up."

If that simple childlike faith is the kind we should have, then the more Word you hear, the more simple and childlike your faith should become. We ought to have museums full of crutches and wheelchairs in Tulsa. That explanation does not hold water.

When I came out of peace, the Lord said, "I can tell you why. It is not just America. It is Japan, Great Britain, Australia, and all these first-world countries as opposed to third-world countries."

I said, "Why, Father?"

I will never forget what He said. He said, "The devil is deathly afraid of the power in the multi-trillions of dollars in first-world countries. He is encamped on the perimeter of revival in first-world countries, and he is camping on the wealth, using the stones and thorns to keep it from being released."

He knows that if a group of people ever crashes through that perimeter through the eighth operation of prayer, begins to punch holes in the devil's lines of defense, and transformation begins to take place, then the multibillions will start pouring into the gospel. It will spread around the world, and this thing will be over.

Any group of people, any man or woman of God, who approaches that perimeter and presses for revival like that, the devil moves in from the four quarters of the earth and beats their brains out. In third-world countries, he does not care as much because they do not have the wealth to spread it everywhere. It usually dies within five miles of where it started.

The Lord told me that in this last decade He was not only having me preach this. He said He was going to raise up people to preach the eighth operation, the purging and power of the Holy Spirit for transformation, character flaws, stones, and thorns. He said He had hundreds of thousands of believers He wanted to pull out of the wheelchair of poverty and make rich in this last decade.

James 5 has to come to pass. The rich men have heaped it up, and it is going to change hands. There will be supernatural revival of money changing hands from the sinner's camp to the believer's camp, and the devil is afraid of it. He is pushing for a one-world monetary system because he wants to destroy the incredible power in money before you and I get it for this last push.

God cannot give it to you until you deal with the character thorns and stones of self-exaltation, lust, and destruction, because the devil will destroy you with it. You may make it and get it, but the kingdom will not have it, and you will not have a reward because of it. Later on, you cannot eat it.

That little widow woman has become my hero. I did not know there was anything about her I needed to know until I began meditating on her. Now she has become my best friend. I will know her when I get to heaven.

She had two mites, and Jesus commented loudly, "This woman has given more than all." The rich Pharisees were throwing large gifts in, and she had two mites. She threw those two mites in, and this went down in the annals of heaven as a testimony for her forever.

He had the audacity to say that this woman gave more than they all.

That is not all about this woman. She pressed past the wealth of the temple. The apostles commented, "Look at these stones," and Jesus said they would not be left one upon another. If they were remarking about the wealth and the stones of the temple, then this widow pressed past the wealth of the temple. It did not bother her that religion had so much and she was destitute. She was not bitter at God because her husband died and left her destitute.

Jesus said she gave more. She even gave of her living. It is not how much you give. It is the faith it takes you to give it, and that is called character development.

Later on in the siege, when rich Pharisees are running through the streets with bags of gold, offering the widow woman fifty thousand dollars for one piece of bread baking in her oven, she will say, "Why did you not give when God wanted it?"

There is coming a time when there will be such transformation revivals, and people will be so changed, that you will hear about revivals where people bring their children with severe disabilities into meetings, and those children will be straightened out by the power of God. The power will so affect the city that multibillionaires will ask, "What price can you put on your son? How can you get something money cannot buy?"

There will be such transformation, and saints will so abandon their lives to God, that it will free God to make them rich. The deceitfulness of riches will not find any thorns to twist up and destroy that person with, because of the eighth operation: godliness with contentment is great gain.

I wish I would have made it, Father, but I do want to say this much in closing tonight.

After I came out of one of Satan's traps, I could not see the forest until I was out of it. If there is one thing the devil fears in your life, one thing that disorients him, it is that you will come to a place where your faith transfers, and you esteem the rewards and glories of heaven as the final and great reward worth everything to you in this life.

Most of us cannot see that far because daily affairs, pressure, and cares keep us fighting to keep our eyes above water. We cannot see past the end of our hand, much less past the barrier of flesh into heaven.

The thing the devil kept hidden from me was the thing by which the elders obtained a good report. I used to preach that the good report was quenching fires, closing the mouths of lions, giving widows their dead back, and waxing valiant in fight. But he also went on to say they were tortured to death, scourged, imprisoned, and put to death. Moses esteemed the afflictions with God's people greater wealth than the wealth of Egypt, and that was called a good report wrought by faith.

You cannot obtain that kind of good report unless your faith somewhere along the line transfers itself and esteems the rewards of heaven as the final and great reward.

When it does, an incredible thing takes place. The things you were fighting for here begin to pour in, because you got free from them. They become your servant instead of you serving them.

This may shock you, but our great faith verse is talking about this:

Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.

Leading up to that verse, Paul said, "You took joyfully the spoiling of your goods, knowing in yourselves that in heaven you had a better and enduring substance." They did not mind people stealing everything they had, throwing them in jail, and torturing them, because they were transformed and renewed in God to the place that they knew within themselves that in heaven they had the real substance. All of this was temporary. It was only an expression of the real.

So when he says, "Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen," he is saying, "What does it matter if they steal all your goods, throw you in prison, and torture you? Your faith is the substance of the thing you have not seen yet."

I have not been to heaven, but I know it exists. You can take my goods, because my faith is all the evidence I need of that place called heaven that I have not seen.

By this kind of faith the elders obtained a good report, because the chains were broken off them. They came to the place where they sought the kingdom of God first and His right standing in it, and everything they needed was added to them.

There is only one way you are going to get there, my friend: through the eighth operation, the Holy Spirit walking you through, bringing you to peace, purging the world out of you, and making the realities of heaven more real than even this earth you walk in. I guarantee you He can do it.

It is Satan's nightmare that you will come to a place where he loses his control and hold over you because you esteem the rewards and glories of heaven worth everything you are fighting for here.